FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

Teach with Sound Garden

A short guide. You do not need to know phonics.

What is this?

Sound Garden teaches reading by **sounds**, one at a time. The learner hears a sound, sees the letter, then reads real words with it.

Your job is small: **sit near, stay calm, and let them tap.** The app does the teaching. You bring the smile.

Your 5 minutes a day

1. **Sit side by side.**
   Phone or tablet between you. A quiet place. No hurry.
2. **Open the app and let it start.**
   It asks about yesterday's sounds first. That is the warm-up.
3. **Listen to the new sound together.**
   Say it back. Say the sound, not the letter name (see page 2).
4. **Let the learner tap. Do not tap for them.**
   Wait. Count to five in your head before you help.
5. **Stop while they still want more.**
   Say: "Great work. We will finish tomorrow." Come back tomorrow.

A child's sitting is about 8 minutes or less. A grown-up learner's sitting is 10 to 15 minutes. Short and every day beats long and rare.

Do

- ◯ Praise the trying
- ◯ Say the sound short and clean
- ◯ Let the mistake happen
- ◯ Come back tomorrow

Do not

- ✕ Say "guess"
- ✕ Say "wrong"
- ✕ Tap for them
- ✕ Compare with a brother, sister or classmate

You need

- ◯ The app (free, no account, works with no internet)
- ◯ 5 quiet minutes
- ◯ This guide, if you like

GOOD TO KNOW There is no streak count and no "you lost" screen. A missed check is not a problem: the app brings those sounds back. Nothing is lost.

This guide: Parents pages 1 to 3 · All 43 sounds pages 4 and 5 · Teachers pages 6 to 8

FOR PARENTS

Say the sounds the right way

Sounds, not letter names. Short, with no "uh".

1 Say the sound, not the name

The letter **m** has a name ("em") and a sound ("mmm"). Reading uses the **sound**. Tap the speaker button in the app to hear it, then copy it.

LETTER	SAY	NOT
s	sss	~~ess~~
m	mmm	~~em~~
f	fff	~~eff~~

2 Keep it short and clean: no "uh" on the end

Some sounds are a quick pop. **p** is a puff of air from the lips, not "puh". **t** is a tap of the tongue, not "tuh". An extra "uh" turns **pat** into "puh-a-tuh", and a learner cannot slide that into a word.

Trick: hold your hand in front of your mouth. A tiny puff is right. A big puff with a voice is too much.

Hold **s**, **m**, **f**, **n**, **l** as long as you like. Say the pops **p**, **t**, **k**, **b**, **d**, **g** quick. Pages 4 and 5 show all 43 sounds.

When to stop for the day

- ◯ Tired, silly, or says "no"? Stop. Say "We will finish tomorrow."
- ◯ One sitting is enough. No second new sound on the same day.
- ◯ Missed a check? No worry. The app brings those sounds back.

Praise this

- ◯ **Trying.** "You tried that one. Good."
- ◯ **Pointing and sliding.** "I like how you slid your finger."
- ◯ **Sounding out.** "You sounded it out. That is real reading."
- ◯ **Coming back.** "You are here again today."

Fix it like this

- ◯ Wrong tap? Say: **"Check it again with me. What sound does this letter make?"**
- ◯ Say the sound once yourself. Do not scold.
- ◯ Then let them tap again.
- ◯ Still stuck? Leave it. The app brings it back.

FOR PARENTS

Keep it going

Little and often. Feeling safe matters most.

If you do not read well yourself

That is fine. You can still do this. The app plays each sound aloud. Tap the speaker button to hear it again. You do not have to know the answer. You only have to sit with the learner and be kind.

When they get a word right, say: **"Yes! You read that."** When it is hard, say: **"Take your time. I am right here."** You are learning too, and that is good for them to see.

If your child is stuck on a word

1. **Wait.**
   Count to five in your head. Most children sort it out alone.
2. **Point under the first letter.**
   Slide your finger left to right under the word, slowly.
3. **Say each sound, one by one.**
   "s ... a ... t". Let them say it with you.
4. **Say them faster.**
   "sss-aaa-t" ... "sat". Slide the sounds together.
5. **Check it makes sense, after.**
   Ask "Does that make sense?" only after the word is read, never to find the word.

Do not say "look at the picture". The app hides the picture until the word is read, on purpose. Guessing is a habit that makes reading harder later.

Short answers

They say the same wrong sound again and again.
Say the sound once, short and clean. Ask them to say it with you, three times. Try again tomorrow.

They mix up b and d.
Very common. Do not worry. Say the sound and feel it: b is a lip pop, d is a tongue tap (page 4).

They are bored.
Stop earlier. Ten happy minutes beat thirty cross ones. A short game from page 8 can help.

We speak another language at home.
Keep it. Use it for talk and stories. Use English only for the sounds, and say them the way the speaker button does.

ALL 43 SOUNDS

How to say each sound

Part 1: 24 consonant sounds. Say the sound, then the word.

LETTERS	SAY	WORD	HOW YOUR MOUTH MOVES	AVOID	DONE
Sounds you can hold: keep your breath going					
s	sss	snake	Teeth close together. Air hisses out. No voice.	AVOID ess	☐
sh	shhh	ship	Lips push forward, teeth close. Like asking for quiet.	AVOID ess-aitch	☐
f	fff	fish	Top teeth rest on the bottom lip. Blow. No voice.	AVOID eff	☐
th	thhh	thumb	Tongue tip between your teeth. Blow softly. No voice.	AVOID tee-aitch	☐
th	thhh	this	Same tongue place, but voice on. Feel your throat buzz.	AVOID dee	☐
m	mmm	mountain	Close your lips and hum. Feel the buzz on your lips.	AVOID em	☐
n	nnn	net	Tongue tip up behind the top teeth. Hum through your nose.	AVOID en	☐
z	zzz	zebra	Like s, but voice on. A buzzing bee.	AVOID zed	☐
v	vvv	van	Top teeth on the bottom lip. Voice on. Feel the buzz.	AVOID vee	☐
r	rrr	rabbit	Tongue pulled back, touching nothing. Lips a little round.	AVOID ar	☐
l	lll	leg	Tongue tip up behind the top teeth. Voice on. You can hold it.	AVOID el	☐
ng	ng	ring	Back of the tongue lifts. Hum through your nose. Ends a word.	AVOID en-gee	☐
Short sounds: say them quick and clean. Never add "uh"					
h	h	horse	Open mouth. A quiet puff of breath, like fogging a window.	AVOID aitch	☐
t	t	tower	Tongue taps the ridge behind the top teeth. Tiny puff. No voice.	AVOID tuh	☐
p	p	pig	Lips pop open. Feel the puff on your hand. No voice.	AVOID puh	☐
c k	k	kangaroo	Back of the tongue taps the roof of the mouth. No voice.	AVOID kuh	☐
ch	ch	cherry	A tap, then a hiss, very fast. No voice.	AVOID chuh	☐
x	ks	box	A quick k, then s. Two sounds, one push.	AVOID ex	☐
qu	kw	queen	A quick k, then lips go round for w.	AVOID cue	☐
nk	nk	pink	The ng hum, then a quick k.	AVOID en-kay	☐
b	b	boot	Lips pop open with your voice on. Touch your throat.	AVOID buh	☐
d	d	duck	Tongue taps behind the top teeth, voice on.	AVOID duh	☐
g	g	girl	Back of the tongue taps, voice on. Way back in your throat.	AVOID guh	☐
j	j	jam	A tap, then a buzz, voice on. A soft buzzy pop.	AVOID juh	☐

ALL 43 SOUNDS

How to say each sound

Part 2: 2 gliding sounds and 17 vowel sounds.

LETTERS	SAY	WORD	HOW YOUR MOUTH MOVES	AVOID	DONE
Gliding sounds: start, then move on straight away					
w	w	web	Lips round like blowing out a candle, then open. Voice on.	AVOID double-you	☐
y	y	yellow	Tongue high and wide, then slide into the next sound.	AVOID why	☐
Vowel sounds: open mouth, voice on, nothing touches					
a	a	apple	Mouth drops open, jaw relaxed. Short.	AVOID ay	☐
e	e	egg	Mouth half open, tongue forward. Short.	AVOID ee	☐
i	i	insect	Almost a smile. Short and quick.	AVOID eye	☐
o	o	octopus	Mouth open and a little round, like the start of "hot".	AVOID oh	☐
u	u	umbrella	Relaxed, half-open mouth. This one really is a small "uh".	AVOID you	☐
ai ay	ai	rain	Starts like e, slides to a smile.	AVOID ay-eye	☐
ee ea	ee	tree	Big smile, lips wide. Hold it.	AVOID ee-ee	☐
igh i_e	igh	kite	Starts with an open mouth, slides to a smile.	AVOID eye-gee-aitch	☐
oa o_e	oa	boat	Lips round and pushed forward a little.	AVOID oh-ay	☐
ow ou	ow	cow	Mouth open, then lips slide round.	AVOID oh-double-you	☐
oo	oo	moon	Lips in a small tight circle. Hold it.	AVOID oh-oh	☐
oo	oo	book	Lips round but loose. Short.	AVOID oh-oh	☐
or aw	or	fork	Lips round, jaw dropped a little. Long.	AVOID oh-ar	☐
er ir ur	er	bird	Lips relaxed, tongue pulled back. No hard r.	AVOID ee-ar	☐
oi oy	oi	boy	Lips round, then slide to a smile.	AVOID oh-eye	☐
ar	ar	car	Mouth wide open, like at the doctor.	AVOID ay-ar	☐
air	air	chair	Mouth half open, ends relaxed.	AVOID ay-eye-ar	☐

CHECK YOURSELF Say the sound in front of a mirror and watch your mouth. A good sound is short and clean, and the shape matches the cue. To say b, d or g with no "uh": say the whole word (boot, duck, girl), then say only the first sound and stop at once. Tap the speaker in the app to compare.

MANY SPELLINGS One sound can be written more than one way (ai and ay, or oa and o_e). The learner meets each spelling in its own lesson. You only need to say the sound the same way each time.

FOR TEACHERS

How a Sound Garden sitting works

One sitting teaches one new sound. Nine short steps.

	STEP	WHAT THE LEARNER DOES	WHAT YOU DO
1	**Warm-up**	Answers questions on yesterday's sounds.	Stay quiet. Watch which sounds are slow.
2	**Hear it**	Listens to the new sound.	Say it back, short and clean.
3	**Meet it**	Sees the letter that makes the sound.	Point to the letter. Use the mouth cue.
4	**Blend it**	Slides sounds together to read a word.	Slide your finger under the letters.
5	**Spell it**	Builds the word with letter tiles.	Say the sounds in order. Do not spell it for them.
6	**Tricky words**	Learns words that break the rules.	Show the odd part (the heart on the printed sheets).
7	**Read it**	Reads a short text and answers questions.	Let them finish. Ask after, not during.
8	**Listen and talk**	Hears a short passage, answers questions.	Talk about it. This builds meaning.
9	**Check**	A short check shows if the sound has stuck.	Do not help with the answers.

The order of the course

Level 1 starts with s, a, t, then p, i, n, and adds one sound per lesson. After that: letter pairs and groups, silent e and vowel pairs, longer words, word parts, then reading to learn.

108 lessons: 14, 14, 18, 16, 16, 16 and 14 across the seven levels.

In a group or class

- ◯ One learner per device is best. Pairs work too.
- ◯ Group by the last check passed, not by age.
- ◯ One new sound a day.
- ◯ Walk the room. Listen for added "uh" sounds. Praise out loud.

What to praise, what to fix

Praise: pointing under letters, saying the sounds, blending without help, trying again after a wrong tap, finishing the sitting.

Fix, gently: naming letters instead of sounds, an added "uh", guessing from a picture or the first letter, skipping letters, answering for the learner.

WHY NO PICTURE FIRST No picture is shown beside a word before it is read. This is on purpose, so the learner reads the letters and does not guess. Pictures come after.

FOR TEACHERS

Progress checklist

Move on when the check is passed and most signs are true.

Name _____ Start date _____ Teacher or parent _____

1 First Sounds 14 lessons

☐ Level check passed Date _____

Learns: The sound of each letter, one at a time, starting with s, a, t. Then blending short words such as sat, pin and mud. A few tricky words such as a, I, the and is.

Ready when: The learner says each sound at once when they see the letter. They read short real words and made-up words, and they pass the Level 1 check.

2 Sounds Together 14 lessons

☐ Level check passed Date _____

Learns: Two letters that make one sound (sh, ch, th, ng). Letter groups at the start and end of words (stop, jump, strap). Endings -s, -ed and -ing. Two small words joined into one (sunset).

Ready when: They read words like ship, stand and jumping without stopping at each letter. They pass the Level 2 check.

3 Long Vowels 18 lessons

☐ Level check passed Date _____

Learns: A silent e that changes the vowel (hop, hope). Vowel pairs such as ai, ee, oa and igh. Soft c and g. ar and or.

Ready when: They hear the difference between hop and hope, and read both. They read words like rain, feet and light. They pass the Level 3 check.

4 Longer Words 16 lessons

☐ Level check passed Date _____

Learns: More vowel patterns (er, oi, ou, aw). Silent letters (knee, write). Breaking long words into parts. A routine for any long word: mark it, peel off the ends, chunk it, blend it, then flex the sounds if it sounds odd.

Ready when: They try a long, new word in chunks without help. They read a simple sign or label. They pass the Level 4 check.

5 Word Power 16 lessons

☐ Level check passed Date _____

Learns: Word pieces: prefixes such as un- and re-, endings such as -ly and -ful, and a few roots. Short texts on water, money and the heart.

Ready when: They work out a new word from its pieces. They read a short text smoothly and say what it was about.

6 Reading to Learn 16 lessons

☐ Level check passed Date _____

Learns: Longer texts about the body, water, money and history. How a text is built. Checking who wrote a page.

Ready when: They state the main idea, and one cause and one effect, in their own words.

7 Advanced and Critical 14 lessons

☐ Level check passed Date _____

Learns: Reading like a historian, reading a science article, judging an argument, and reading a contract or policy.

Ready when: They can state a claim, give its reasons, and say what is missing.

FOR TEACHERS

Using the printed practice pages

Free, in the app, and they work with no internet.

How to get them

1. **Open "For grown-ups" in the app.**
   Hold the button for two seconds, then answer the sum.
2. **Open "Print practice".**
   Pick a lesson and tap Print practice. Or pick a whole level.
3. **Print on A4 or US Letter.**
   Black and white is fine. Nothing needs colour.

On a sheet (Levels 1 to 4)

- ◯ **Meet the new sounds.** You say it, the child copies.
- ◯ **Sound buttons.** Tap each dot or dash, say the sound, slide it together.
- ◯ **Find the letters.** Circle each one.
- ◯ **Read the words,** then again, faster.
- ◯ **Read the sentences.** Point under each word.
- ◯ **Tricky words.** The heart marks the part to learn by heart.
- ◯ **Write.** Lines for letters and words.

Levels 5 to 7

These are reading and thinking lessons built on a long text. The text is in the app. The sheet is short: the word list and a writing task.

In Levels 1 to 4, every word to read uses only sounds already taught.

One sheet in 10 minutes

1. **Warm up (1 min).**
   Point to each sound card. Say it, the learner says it.
2. **Sound buttons (3 min).**
   Do the first word together. Then let them do the next.
3. **Read the words (3 min).**
   Slowly the first time, faster the second.
4. **Sentences, then tick (3 min).**
   Point under each word. Ask one question. Let them tick the box.

Two-minute games, no paper

Say it slowly. You say "s-u-n". The learner says "sun" fast. Then swap.

Sound hunt. Pick a sound. Find things around you that start with it. Take turns.

REMEMBER File L2.05 matches lesson 2.05. Print it **after** the sitting, not instead of it.